

In 1896, after three years abroad, Gandhi returned to India. It was not easy for him to leave his important work with the Natal Indian Congress behind. But Gandhi wanted his family to join him in South Africa. So Kasturbai, a nephew, and his two sons, now ages nine and five, made the return trip with him.

Once they arrived in Natal, Gandhi insisted they dress in uncomfortable clothing, such as stockings and shoes, and use utensils, such as knives and forks, like most Indians in South Africa. Kasturbai did her best to follow her husband’s wishes in running her new South African household. But she did not always agree with him.